# ICP question bank: what Dot’s buyers ask, October 2026

Oct 23, 2026 · Saurabh Sharma

## How this bank was built

Nobody can see what people type into ChatGPT or Claude. Google publishes search volume; AI assistants publish nothing. So every question here is marked with where its demand was seen, and the bank is honest about which questions are observed and which are inferred.

**Sources read on 22–23 October 2026**

| Source | What it told me |
|---|---|
| Dot’s blog index, 110+ posts, and one listicle read in full | What Dot already answers, and in what format |
| Dot’s docs (llms.txt, Evaluation, Agent Compute Credits, Files, integrations) | What Dot can actually do, so questions map to real capability |
| Querio’s content library (ad hoc bottleneck, eval framework, lean teams, Cortex vs Genie, Genie limits) | The competitor running the same playbook; where they rank is where buyers search |
| Metabase, Sigma, Fabi, Coefficient on ad hoc requests | Four vendors answering the same buyer pain means the pain is real and searched |
| Atlan on Cortex Analyst vs custom text-to-SQL, citing Reddit practitioner reports | DIY pipelines plateau at 60–70% accuracy; trust collapses when a third to a half of answers are wrong; context improved accuracy by 38% in Atlan’s benchmark |
| Tableau’s accuracy framework, Snowflake and Mistral’s Cortex claims (90%+) | What "accurate" means to vendors versus to buyers |
| Basedash and InfiniSynapse comparison pages | The warehouse-native versus third-party question is live and contested |
| Buster’s memo, vutr’s "Why is text-to-SQL so hard", AWS text-to-SQL best practices | How practitioners frame the problem technically |

| Source | What it told me |
|---|---|
| parse.gl's GEO profile of getdot.ai | A tracker already measures how AI assistants describe and cite Dot; useful for the baseline |

**Two labels on every question**

- **Observed**: I saw this question, or a page built to answer it, in a search result, a vendor's content or a practitioner thread. Demand is real; volume is unknown until Ahrefs.
- **Inferred**: nobody has written a page for it yet, but the product, the market in late 2026, or the buyer's situation makes it a question she asks. These are hypotheses to validate on the day.

Inferred questions are the valuable ones. Observed questions have competition. Inferred questions with real demand are the gap.

**What to do with this on 27 October:** take every question with a score of 9 or above into Ahrefs for volume and difficulty, run the eight AI prompts in section 9, and ask Rick and Théo for ten questions from real sales calls. Then re-rank. The bank is a seed, not a finding.

## Who is asking, and what kind of question

**Three personas.** They ask different questions, in different words, at different moments.

| Persona | Role in the deal | What she is trying to do | How she phrases it |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Head of Data / Analytics Lead** | Buyer and owner of the outcome | Get her team out of the request queue without losing control of the numbers; answer the CEO's "what are we doing with AI" | Strategic, outcome-first: "how do I reduce", "is it worth", "what does good look like" |

| Persona | Role in the deal | What she is trying to do | How she phrases it |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Analytics Engineer / Data Engineer** | Implementer and technical evaluator; often the one who kills or saves the deal | Know whether it will be accurate on *their* schema, what it needs from dbt, how it fits CI, what breaks | Technical, mechanism-first: "how does it handle", "does it support", "what happens when" |
| **Operating leader (COO, CFO, Head of Ops, VP Product)** | The stakeholder who feels the queue; sometimes the trigger | Get answers this week without waiting on the data team; not embarrass herself with a wrong number | Impatient, value-first: "can we just", "why does it take", "what would it cost" |

**Who is not the ICP for content.** The end business user who asks "how many orders did we ship in March" is Dot's *user*, not its *buyer*. Her questions go into Dot, not into Google. Content written for her produces traffic that never converts. Every question below is one the three personas above would type into a search box or an AI assistant.

**Four question types, four funnel stages.** The type decides the format, the evidence and whether Dot is mentioned at all.

| Type | Stage | She knows | Dot's right move | Who owns it at Dot today |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1 · Problem** | Problem-aware | She has a pain. She does not know the category exists. | Answer the pain honestly. Mention Dot late or not at all. | Nobody. The gap. |
| **2 · Evaluation** | Solution-aware | The category exists. She is deciding whether it is real, safe and worth it. | Evidence: tests, numbers, walkthroughs. Dot earns the mention. | Rick's essays, partially |

| Type | Stage | She knows | Dot's right move | Who owns it at Dot today |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **3 · Comparison** | Vendor selection | She has a shortlist. | Comparison pages. Dot is the subject. | Théo's engine. Covered. |
| **4 · Implementation** | Post-decision | She has bought or nearly bought. | How-to with screenshots. Dot is the tool. | Docs, partially |

Types 1 and 2 are where Google traffic and AI citations come from, because that is where the buyer has a question and no vendor in mind. Type 4 is where conversion happens and churn is prevented. Type 3 is already handled.

## How each question is scored

Four factors, each 1 to 3. Maximum 12. The score decides what gets written first; it is not a measure of how important the question is to the buyer.

| Factor | 1 | 2 | 3 | How to validate on the day |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Demand** | Inferred only | Observed in one source | Observed in three or more sources, or a vendor built a page for it | Ahrefs volume and "People also ask"; count of vendors with a page |
| **Gap at Dot** | Dot has a page that answers it | Dot touches it in passing (an essay, a docs page) | Dot has nothing | Site search on getdot.ai; Ahrefs top pages |
| **Weak incumbent** | A strong, evidence-backed page ranks | Decent pages rank, none with original evidence | Only generic, undated or vendor-pitch pages rank | Read the top three results; note date, evidence, author |

| Factor | 1 | 2 | 3 | How to validate on the day |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Evidence advantage** | Anyone could write it | Dot's customer proof helps | Only running Dot (an eval, a Root walkthrough, a Deep Analysis) can produce the evidence | Can the piece contain a screenshot nobody else can take? |

A 12 is a question many buyers ask, nobody at Dot has answered, the current answers are thin, and Dot can prove something. A 4 is a question Dot already owns or that anyone could answer as well.

The scores below are my estimates from the sources read. Treat them as a first sort. Ahrefs and the sales-call questions will move some of them by two or three points, and that movement is the thing to show Rick and Théo: the method survives contact with data.

## Type 1 · Problem questions (34)

She has a pain and no vendor in mind. These are the questions that bring Google traffic and AI citations, and they are the ones Dot has not written for. Columns: the short form she types into Google; the long form she types into ChatGPT or Claude; who asks; whether demand was observed or inferred and where; who ranks today; whether Dot has a page; score.

### 1.1 · The queue

The data team is the bottleneck and everyone knows it. In late 2026 this is sharper than before: CEOs expect AI to have fixed it already, business users have ChatGPT and are tempted to use it on exports, and the team has not grown. Four vendors (Querio, Metabase, Sigma, Fabi) have pages here. Dot has none.

| # | Google form | How she asks an AI | Who | Demand | Who answers today | Dot | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | reduce ad hoc data requests | My data team of three spends half its week answering Slack questions. How do I cut the volume without telling people no? | Head of Data | Observed: Querio, Metabase, Sigma, Fabi, Coefficient | Querio (good), Metabase (2022), Sigma case study | None | 12 |
| 2 | data team bottleneck | How do I stop my data team being the bottleneck for every decision? | Head of Data, COO | Observed: Querio "Stop Being the Bottleneck" | Querio | None | 11 |
| 3 | how to audit data requests | How do I count and categorise the requests my data team gets so I can see what is repetitive? | Head of Data | Observed: Querio and Fabi both say "review the last 90 days"; none shows a template | Generic advice, no template | None | 12 |
| 4 | what percentage of data requests are repetitive | What share of a typical data team's requests are repeat metric lookups versus real analysis? | Head of Data | Observed: Querio cites 40–50% repeats; Chargebee reported 80 of 350 per quarter | Querio, metadata weekly | None | 10 |
| 5 | data request intake process | Should I use a ticketing system for data requests, or does that make the problem worse? | Head of Data | Observed: Metabase | Metabase | None | 8 |
| 6 | how to say no to data requests | How do I push back on low-value data requests without damaging relationships? | Head of Data, Analytics Lead | Inferred | Nothing specific | None | 7 |

| # | Google form | How she asks an AI | Who | Demand | Who answers today | Dot | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 7 | data team slack channel best practices | How should a data team run its Slack help channel so it does not become a 24-hour help desk? | Analytics Lead | Inferred | Nothing specific | None | 8 |
| 8 | data requests take days | Why does a simple data question take my data team three days, and what would make it three minutes? | COO, VP Product | Observed: Querio states 2–5 business days for routine requests | Querio | None | 9 |

## 1.2 · Self-service that did not work

Most buyers have already tried self-service: dashboards, a BI tool, training. It half-worked. The questions are about why, and what to do next. This cluster has a subtle advantage: the buyer is already disappointed with the category Dot is adjacent to, so an honest answer earns more trust than a pitch.

| # | Google form | How she asks an AI | Who | Demand | Who answers today | Dot | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 9 | why self-service analytics fails | We rolled out dashboards and training and the requests did not go down. Why does self-service analytics keep failing? | Head of Data | Observed: Querio "lean data teams" piece; Sigma, Metabase | Querio | Self-service how-to exists, not the failure mode | 9 |
| 10 | dashboards nobody uses | We have 200 dashboards and people still ask the data team. What went wrong? | Head of Data | Inferred; common practitioner complaint | Scattered essays | None | 9 |

| # | Google form | How she asks an AI | Who | Demand | Who answers today | Dot | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 11 | self-service analytics small data team | How does a two-person data team give 300 people self-service without losing control of the numbers? | Head of Data | Observed: Querio targets exactly this | Querio | None | 11 |
| 12 | business users export to Excel | Everyone exports dashboards to Excel and builds their own numbers. How do I stop the spreadsheet sprawl? | Analytics Lead | Observed: Querio mentions sprawl | Thin | None | 9 |
| 13 | self-service analytics governance | How do I let business teams answer their own questions without them inventing metrics? | Head of Data, Analytics Engineer | Observed: Querio, Metabase | Querio | Semantic-layer essay touches it | 8 |
| 14 | data literacy training does not work | We trained everyone on the BI tool and nothing changed. Is data literacy training worth it? | Head of Data | Inferred | Opinion pieces | None | 8 |
| 15 | conversational analytics vs dashboards | Will chat-based analytics replace dashboards, or do we need both? | Head of Data, VP Product | Observed: Querio, Basedash | Querio | Rick touches it in essays | 7 |

## 1.3 · Small team, big company

Dot's customers are 100 to 1,000 people with a data team of two to ten. That ratio is the whole problem. Questions here are about prioritisation, hiring versus tooling, and what a team that size should even be doing.

| # | Google form | How she asks an AI | Who | Demand | Who answers today | Dot | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 16 | data team size ratio company | How many data people does a 300-person company need? Is one analyst per 100 employees normal? | Head of Data, CFO | Inferred; a known benchmark question | Scattered, dated | None | 9 |
| 17 | hire another analyst or buy a tool | Should I hire a second analyst or spend that money on tooling? How do I decide? | Head of Data, CFO | Inferred | Nothing honest | None | 10 |
| 18 | first data hire what to prioritise | I am the first data person at a 150-person company. What do I build first and what do I refuse? | Analytics Lead | Observed: Dot has a "data culture by company stage" piece | Dot, partially | Partial | 6 |
| 19 | data team roadmap 100 to 1000 employees | What should a data team look like as a company grows from 100 to 1,000 people? | Head of Data | Observed: Dot's stage piece | Dot, partially | Partial | 5 |
| 20 | analytics engineer vs data analyst small team | With one hire, should it be an analytics engineer or an analyst? | Head of Data | Inferred | dbt community posts | None | 7 |

| # | Google form | How she asks an AI | Who | Demand | Who answers today | Dot | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 21 | data team burnout ad hoc | My analysts are burning out on requests. What do I change this quarter? | Head of Data | Observed: Metabase "avoiding analyst burnout" | Metabase (2022) | None | 9 |

## 1.4 · The CEO said "AI-first"

New in 2025–2026. Leadership has mandated AI; the Head of Data has to answer "what are we doing with it" by the next board meeting. She is searching for what is real. Meanwhile business users are already pasting exports into ChatGPT, which is the question underneath all of these.

| # | Google form | How she asks an AI | Who | Demand | Who answers today | Dot | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 22 | what can AI do for a data team | My CEO wants an AI plan for the data team by next month. What actually works today and what is hype? | Head of Data | Inferred; strongly situational in 2026 | Consultancy pieces, generic | Rick's essays, partially | 9 |
| 23 | employees using chatgpt on company data | People are uploading exports to ChatGPT to analyse them. Is that a security problem, and what do I offer instead? | Head of Data, CFO | Inferred; a real 2026 incident pattern | Security vendors | None | 11 |

| # | Google form | How she asks an AI | Who | Demand | Who answers today | Dot | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 24 | can chatgpt query our database | Can I just connect ChatGPT or Claude to our warehouse and let people ask questions? What goes wrong? | Analytics Engineer | Observed: Dot has "ChatGPT vs AI data analyst" and a Claude Code piece | Dot, partially; Buster memo | Partial | 7 |
| 25 | ai data analyst for small team | Is an AI data analyst realistic for a team of two, or is it an enterprise thing? | Head of Data | Inferred | Listicles | Listicles only | 8 |
| 26 | will ai replace data analysts 2026 | Should I be worried about my job, or my team's jobs, if we roll out an AI analyst? | Analytics Lead, Analytics Engineer | Observed: Buster memo asks it; widespread | Opinion | None | 7 |
| 27 | ai first data strategy | What does an AI-first data strategy look like for a mid-size company, in practice? | Head of Data | Inferred | Consultancies | None | 8 |
| 28 | how to measure ai impact on data team | How do I prove to the CEO that AI saved my team time? What do I measure? | Head of Data | Inferred | Nothing specific | Impact studies are the proof but not the how-to | 10 |

## 1.5 · Two dashboards disagree

The trust problem predates AI and AI makes it worse. If the revenue number differs between finance and sales, an AI that answers instantly answers wrongly instantly. These questions are about metric ownership and definitions, and they are the on-ramp to Dot's semantic-layer and context story.

| # | Google form | How she asks an AI | Who | Demand | Who answers today | Dot | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 29 | two dashboards show different numbers | Finance and sales report different revenue. How do I find out why and stop it recurring? | Head of Data, CFO | Inferred; universal | dbt community, Metabase | Semantic-layer essay | 8 |
| 30 | metric definitions document template | How do I write down our metric definitions so everyone, including an AI, uses the same ones? | Analytics Engineer | Observed: Querio "certify 10–20 KPIs" | Querio, dbt docs | Essay only, no template | 11 |
| 31 | who owns metric definitions | Who should own the definition of revenue, active user, churn: finance, product or the data team? | Head of Data | Inferred | Opinion | None | 8 |
| 32 | single source of truth metrics | How do I get to one version of the truth without rebuilding the whole data stack? | Head of Data | Observed: Querio, every BI vendor | Vendors | Essays | 6 |

| # | Google form | How she asks an AI | Who | Demand | Who answers today | Dot | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 33 | metric glossary vs data catalog | Do I need a data catalog, a metric glossary, a semantic layer, or all three? | Analytics Engineer | Observed: Querio "semantic layer vs metric glossary"-adjacent | Querio, Atlan | Essay, partially | 9 |
| 34 | how to define active user | How should we define an active user so the definition holds up when an AI uses it? | Analytics Engineer, VP Product | Inferred; Buster memo uses it as the example | Scattered | None | 8 |

# Type 2 · Evaluation questions (39)

She knows AI data analysts exist. She is deciding whether they are real, safe and worth it. This is where Dot can produce evidence nobody else can: an evaluation run, a Root walkthrough, a cost per question. It is also where the analytics engineer enters, and she will decide on mechanism, not promise.

## 2.1 · Accuracy and trust

The question underneath every other question. Practitioners on Reddit report DIY text-to-SQL plateauing at 60–70% and trust collapsing once a third of answers are wrong; vendors claim 90%+. The buyer has heard both and believes neither. What she wants is a way to test it herself, on her data, before anyone relies on it. Querio has a framework page. Dot has a benchmark (DABstep), an accuracy page, and a built-in Evaluation feature, and no how-to.

| # | Google form | How she asks an AI | Who | Demand | Who answers today | Dot | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 35 | how to evaluate AI data analyst accuracy | How do I test whether an AI data analyst gives correct answers before rolling it out? | Head of Data, Analytics Engineer | Observed: Querio framework; Tableau; Atlan; neurlcreators | Querio (framework, no result) | Accuracy page, DABstep post; no how-to | 12 |
| 36 | AI data analyst test questions | What questions should I use to test an AI analyst, and how many do I need? | Analytics Engineer | Observed: Querio says 50–100 from query logs | Querio | None | 11 |
| 37 | text to SQL accuracy benchmark business questions | What accuracy should I expect on real business questions, not academic benchmarks? | Analytics Engineer | Observed: Atlan citing Reddit 60–70%; Snowflake 90%+; DABstep | Atlan, vendors | DABstep post | 9 |
| 38 | AI analytics hallucination | What happens when the AI confidently returns a wrong number, and how would anyone know? | Head of Data | Observed: neurlcreators, Tableau | Scattered | None | 10 |
| 39 | why does AI analyst accuracy drop over time | We tested it and it was fine. Why is it worse three months later? | Analytics Engineer | Observed: Dot's own essay on drift | Dot | Rick's essay, strong | 4 |
| 40 | how to measure AI analytics accuracy ongoing | How do I keep measuring accuracy after launch, not just at evaluation? | Analytics Engineer | Observed: Dot docs have Evaluations in CI | Querio, Tableau | Docs only | 10 |

| # | Google form | How she asks an AI | Who | Demand | Who answers today | Dot | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 41 | AI analyst shows SQL | Why does it matter whether the AI shows its SQL, and would anyone on my team read it? | Head of Data | Observed: Querio, Basedash emphasise visible SQL | Vendors | Product page | 7 |
| 42 | ambiguous business questions AI | What does a good AI analyst do when the question is ambiguous, like "best month"? | Analytics Engineer | Inferred; Buster memo and vutr discuss it | Technical blogs | None | 9 |
| 43 | AI analyst follow-up questions context | Does it keep context across follow-ups, and how do I test that? | Analytics Engineer | Observed: Querio eval framework includes follow-ups | Querio | None | 8 |

## 2.2 · Context, semantic layer, glossary

The mechanism behind accuracy. Atlan's benchmark says context improved text-to-SQL accuracy by 38%; every vendor says "it depends on your semantic layer". The buyer's question is practical: what do I have to prepare, how much, and does it have to be dbt? Dot's Root agent and its "context is all you need" docs are the product answer; Rick's semantic-layer essay is the argument. Neither is a how-to.

| # | Google form | How she asks an AI | Who | Demand | Who answers today | Dot | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 44 | metric glossary for AI analytics | What metric definitions do I need to write before an AI analyst answers anyone? | Analytics Engineer | Observed: Querio "10–20 KPIs"; Buster memo | Querio | Essay; docs on Notes | 11 |

| # | Google form | How she asks an AI | Who | Demand | Who answers today | Dot | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 45 | do I need a semantic layer for AI analytics | Do I have to build a semantic layer first, or can the AI work without one? | Head of Data, Analytics Engineer | Observed: Cortex requires Semantic Views; Querio; vutr | Querio, Snowflake docs | Rick's essay, strong argument | 7 |
| 46 | dbt semantic layer AI | We have dbt. Does that mean we are ready for an AI analyst, and what else is needed? | Analytics Engineer | Observed: Dot has dbt integration pages | Docs | Docs, no narrative | 8 |
| 47 | how much context does AI analyst need | How much documentation is enough? Can I start with ten definitions, or do I need everything? | Analytics Engineer | Inferred | Nothing specific | None | 10 |
| 48 | AI analyst learns from dashboards | Can it learn our business logic from existing Tableau or Looker dashboards instead of me writing it? | Analytics Engineer | Observed: Dot's BI integrations say exactly this | Dot docs | Docs, no walkthrough | 9 |
| 49 | context agent data | What is a context agent, and how is it different from a semantic layer? | Analytics Engineer | Inferred; Dot's own term | Dot only | Product page | 6 |
| 50 | metric definitions version control | Should metric definitions live in Git? How do we review changes to what the AI believes? | Analytics Engineer | Observed: Dot docs on version control | Docs | Docs | 7 |

| # | Google form | How she asks an AI | Who | Demand | Who answers today | Dot | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 51 | AI analyst undocumented data | Our warehouse is a mess with no documentation. Is an AI analyst pointless until we fix that? | Head of Data | Inferred; common objection | Nothing honest | None | 10 |

## 2.3 · Security, governance, permissions

The question that ends deals in Europe. Dot's buyers are in Germany, the Netherlands, the Nordics, the UK. The analytics engineer asks about row-level security; the Head of Data asks about GDPR and where the data goes; the CFO asks whether the EU AI Act applies. Dot's answers are in the docs and the security page. Nobody has written the buyer's version.

| # | Google form | How she asks an AI | Who | Demand | Who answers today | Dot | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 52 | AI data analyst row level security | How do I make sure the AI only shows each person the rows they are allowed to see? | Analytics Engineer | Observed: Dot docs on permissions, Immuta | Docs | Docs | 8 |
| 53 | does AI analytics send data to OpenAI | Does my data leave my warehouse? Does the LLM provider see it or train on it? | Head of Data, CFO | Observed: universal vendor-evaluation question | Vendor security pages | Security page | 8 |
| 54 | GDPR AI data analyst | What do I need to check for GDPR before letting an AI query customer data? | Head of Data | Inferred; strong in DACH | Law firms, generic | None | 10 |

| # | Google form | How she asks an AI | Who | Demand | Who answers today | Dot | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 55 | EU AI Act analytics tools | Does the EU AI Act apply to an AI that answers questions from our warehouse? | Head of Data, CFO | Inferred; 2025–2026 timeline | Law firms | None | 9 |
| 56 | AI analyst PII | How do I stop the AI from surfacing personal data in an answer? | Analytics Engineer | Inferred | Scattered | Docs on permissions | 8 |
| 57 | AI analytics audit log | Can I see every question asked and every query run? Who asked what? | Analytics Engineer, Head of Data | Inferred | Vendor docs | Docs | 7 |
| 58 | SOC 2 AI data tools | What security certifications should I require from an AI analytics vendor? | Head of Data | Observed: vendor checklists | Generic checklists | Security page | 6 |
| 59 | AI analyst data residency EU | Can it run in the EU only? Where are the models hosted? | Head of Data | Inferred; strong in DACH | Vendor pages | Security page mentions EU/US | 7 |

## 2.4 · Cost and ROI

She has to put a number in a budget request. Dot prices in Agent Compute Credits, not seats, which most buyers have not seen before. The question is what it costs per question, per month, at scale, and how to prove it paid for itself. Dot's impact studies are the proof; nobody has written the method.

| # | Google form | How she asks an AI | Who | Demand | Who answers today | Dot | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 60 | AI data analyst pricing comparison | How are AI analysts priced: per seat, per query, per credit? Which is better for a 300-person company? | Head of Data, CFO | Observed: Théo's pricing posts for competitors | Dot's pricing posts | Pricing page, listicles | 6 |
| 61 | cost per question AI analytics | What does one answered question cost, and how does that compare to an analyst's hour? | CFO, Head of Data | Inferred; Dot's credit model invites it | Nothing | Credits docs | 11 |
| 62 | ROI of AI data analyst | How do I build the ROI case for an AI analyst? What do I measure before and after? | Head of Data | Observed: Dot has ROI numbers (Choco 18x) but not the method | Vendors with claims | Impact studies | 10 |
| 63 | hours saved by AI analytics how to measure | How did Duolingo measure 12,000 hours saved? Can I measure the same thing? | Head of Data | Observed: Dot's own claim invites the question | Dot's study | Impact study, not method | 9 |
| 64 | AI analytics cost control | How do I stop one power user burning the whole credit budget? | Head of Data | Observed: Dot docs on caps and the 30-credit pause | Docs | Docs | 7 |
| 65 | AI analyst vs hiring analyst cost | Is an AI analyst cheaper than a junior analyst, honestly, once you include setup and maintenance? | CFO, Head of Data | Inferred | Nothing honest | None | 10 |
| 66 | AI analytics pilot cost | What does a 30-day pilot cost and what should it prove? | Head of Data | Inferred | Nothing | Free plan exists | 8 |

## 2.5 · Build, buy, or use what the warehouse gives you

The 2026 question. Snowflake ships Cortex Analyst, Databricks ships Genie, Looker ships conversational analytics, and the analytics engineer can wire Claude to the warehouse through MCP in an afternoon. The buyer's honest question is why she should pay a third party. Querio, Basedash and InfiniSynapse have comparison pages; Dot has alternatives listicles. Nobody has written the decision honestly, including when the answer is "use what you have".

| # | Google form | How she asks an AI | Who | Demand | Who answers today | Dot | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 67 | Cortex Analyst vs third party AI analyst | We are on Snowflake. Should we just use Cortex Analyst, or is a vendor worth it? | Analytics Engineer, Head of Data | Observed: Querio, Basedash, Atlan | Querio | Alternatives listicle | 9 |
| 68 | Databricks Genie limitations | What can Genie not do that a dedicated AI analyst can? | Analytics Engineer | Observed: Querio, InfiniSynapse | Querio, InfiniSynapse | Alternatives listicle | 8 |
| 69 | build vs buy AI data analyst | Should we build our own with Claude or OpenAI and MCP, or buy? What does build actually cost over a year? | Analytics Engineer, Head of Data | Observed: Atlan on DIY plateau; Dot's Claude Code piece | Atlan | Claude Code piece, partially | 10 |
| 70 | Looker conversational analytics vs AI analyst | We have Looker. Is its conversational feature enough? | Analytics Engineer | Observed: Basedash | Basedash | Looker integration docs | 8 |

| # | Google form | How she asks an AI | Who | Demand | Who answers today | Dot | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 71 | AI analyst multiple data sources | Our data is in Snowflake, Sheets and Notion. Can one AI answer across all of them? | Analytics Engineer | Observed: InfiniSynapse frames "cross-source" | InfiniSynapse | Integrations list | 8 |
| 72 | when not to buy AI analytics | When is an AI analyst the wrong purchase? What has to be true first? | Head of Data | Inferred | Nothing honest | None | 10 |
| 73 | AI analyst with MCP Claude Code | Can my engineers query the warehouse from Claude Code or Cursor through the same AI analyst? | Analytics Engineer | Observed: Dot docs on CLI and MCP | Docs | Docs, one post | 7 |

## Type 3 · Comparison questions (8)

She has a shortlist. Théo's engine owns this stage: roughly sixty "alternatives", "pricing" and "versus" pages, templated, sourced, published in batches. These are listed so the bank is complete, not because they need writing. One gap is marked.

| # | Google form | Who | Who answers today | Dot | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 74 | best AI data analyst tools 2026 | Head of Data | Dot, Querio, G2, every vendor | Listicle | 3 |
| 75 | [competitor] alternatives | Head of Data | Dot, in volume | Listicle | 3 |
| 76 | [competitor] pricing | Head of Data | Dot, in volume | Pricing post | 3 |
| 77 | [competitor] vs [competitor] vs Dot | Head of Data | Dot | Versus post | 3 |

| # | Google form | Who | Who answers today | Dot | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 78 | AI data analyst for Snowflake and Looker | Analytics Engineer | Dot, Querio | Integration pages | 5 |
| 79 | AI data analyst Slack | Head of Data | Dot, Querio | Integration page | 5 |
| 80 | AI analytics tools G2 reviews | Head of Data | G2 | None | 4 |
| 81 | **AI data analyst comparison by what breaks** | Analytics Engineer | Nobody | None | **9** |

Question 81 is the one gap: every comparison page says what each tool does. None says what each tool does when the question is ambiguous, the schema is undocumented, or the metric is defined two ways. A comparison built on the same 25-question test run against three tools, with the failures shown, would be cited for a year. It needs access to the other tools, so it is a week-three piece, not a day-two piece.

## Type 4 · Implementation questions (21)

She has bought, or is in a trial. These questions decide whether the pilot converts and whether the customer renews. They have less search volume than Type 1 but far higher intent, and they are answered today only by docs, which explain the feature rather than the decision. The analytics engineer asks most of them.

### 4.1 · Rollout

The first thirty days. Which team first, which questions first, Slack or the app, how to announce it, what to say when it is wrong in week one. Nobody has written this for AI analysts specifically; the self-service rollout literature is about dashboards.

| # | Google form | How she asks an AI | Who | Demand | Who answers today | Dot | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 82 | AI data analyst pilot plan | How do I run a 30-day pilot of an AI analyst that actually proves something? | Head of Data | Inferred; Dot's free plan makes it live | Nothing | Getting-started docs | 10 |

| # | Google form | How she asks an AI | Who | Demand | Who answers today | Dot | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 83 | which team to roll out AI analytics first | Which team should get it first: finance, ops, product, sales? What makes a good first team? | Head of Data | Inferred | Nothing | None | 9 |
| 84 | first questions to give AI analyst | What are the first twenty questions I should load it with, and where do I get them? | Analytics Engineer | Inferred; connects to the audit (Q3) | Nothing | None | 10 |
| 85 | AI analyst in Slack rollout | How do I introduce an AI analyst into Slack without it becoming a toy or a nuisance? | Head of Data | Observed: Dot's Slack docs, channel routing | Docs | Docs | 8 |
| 86 | AI analyst change management | How do I get business teams to ask the AI before they ask my team? | Head of Data | Inferred | Generic change management | None | 9 |
| 87 | AI analyst wrong answer week one | It gave a wrong number in front of the CFO in the first week. What do I do now? | Head of Data | Inferred; the moment pilots die | Nothing | Docs on feedback | 10 |
| 88 | AI analyst permissions setup | How do I set up who can see what before I open it to the company? | Analytics Engineer | Observed: Dot docs | Docs | Docs | 6 |

| # | Google form | How she asks an AI | Who | Demand | Who answers today | Dot | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 89 | AI analyst vs data team roles after rollout | What does my team do differently once the AI handles the routine questions? | Head of Data | Inferred | Opinion | Rick's essays, partially | 8 |

## 4.2 · Operating

After the first month. Who maintains the context, how feedback becomes correction, how to catch drift before the CFO does, what lives in Git. Dot's docs cover the features (Evaluation, Root, Environments, version control, user feedback); nobody has written the operating model.

| # | Google form | How she asks an AI | Who | Demand | Who answers today | Dot | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 90 | who maintains AI analyst context | Who owns keeping the AI's knowledge current: the analytics engineer, the data team, or each business team? | Head of Data | Inferred | Nothing | Docs on Maintaining Dot | 9 |
| 91 | AI analyst feedback loop | How does a thumbs-down become a fix? What does the loop look like in practice? | Analytics Engineer | Observed: Dot docs on user feedback | Docs | Docs | 8 |
| 92 | evaluations in CI for AI analytics | How do I run accuracy checks automatically when definitions change? | Analytics Engineer | Observed: Dot docs "Evaluations in CI" | Docs | Docs, no narrative | 8 |

| # | Google form | How she asks an AI | Who | Demand | Who answers today | Dot | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 93 | AI analyst drift monitoring | How do I know the AI is getting worse before someone tells me? | Analytics Engineer | Observed: Dot's drift essay | Dot | Essay plus docs; no operating how-to | 7 |
| 94 | AI analyst staging environment | Can I test a change to definitions before it goes live to everyone? | Analytics Engineer | Observed: Dot docs on Environments | Docs | Docs | 6 |
| 95 | AI analyst business questions only | How do I stop people asking it to write poems on the company's credits? | Head of Data | Observed: Dot docs "Business questions only" | Docs | Docs | 5 |
| 96 | AI analyst usage metrics | What should I track to know whether the rollout is working: questions per week, repeat users, accuracy? | Head of Data | Inferred | Nothing | None | 9 |

## 4.3 · Expanding

Once it works, what else. Scheduled reports, alerts, apps, embedding, agents. Lower search volume, highest expansion value.

| # | Google form | How she asks an AI | Who | Demand | Who answers today | Dot | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 97 | AI generated weekly report Slack | Can the Monday metrics report write itself and post to Slack? | Head of Data, COO | Observed: Dot docs on Scheduling | Docs | Docs, product page | 7 |

| # | Google form | How she asks an AI | Who | Demand | Who answers today | Dot | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 98 | AI analyst alerts anomalies | Can it tell me when a number moves before I ask? | Head of Data | Observed: Dot's alerts feature | Docs | Product page | 7 |
| 99 | replace dashboards with AI apps | Should we rebuild dashboards as AI-generated apps, or keep the BI tool? | Head of Data | Observed: Dot's BI integration says "rebuild dashboards as Dot apps" | Dot only | Docs | 8 |
| 100 | embed AI analyst in product | Can we give our own customers an AI analyst over their data inside our product? | VP Product | Observed: Dot docs on Embed | Docs | Docs | 6 |
| 101 | AI data analyst for agents | Can other AI agents call the data analyst as a tool? | Analytics Engineer | Observed: Dot docs on API and MCP | Docs | Docs | 6 |
| 102 | root cause analysis AI | When revenue drops, can it tell me why, not just that it dropped? | Head of Data, COO | Observed: Dot has a root-cause how-to | Dot | How-to exists | 5 |

## The ranked shortlist

102 questions, scored. The top fifteen by score, before Ahrefs and before the sales-call questions. Three things stand out: every question at 11 or 12 is in Type 1 or Type 2; none is a comparison; and the top three form a single rollout path a buyer walks in order.

| Rank | # | Question | Type | Score | Why it is here |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 1 | reduce ad hoc data requests | Problem | 12 | Five vendors have a page; Dot has none; the audit is evidence nobody has shown |
| 2 | 3 | how to audit data requests | Problem | 12 | Everyone says "review 90 days of requests"; nobody shows the template or the result |

| Rank | # | Question | Type | Score | Why it is here |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 3 | 35 | how to evaluate AI data analyst accuracy | Evaluation | 12 | Querio has a framework; Dot has the feature and the benchmark and can show a real run |
| 4 | 2 | data team bottleneck | Problem | 11 | Querio's best page; beatable with the Choco and KRY proof |
| 5 | 11 | self-service analytics small data team | Problem | 11 | Exactly Dot's customer; Querio targets it |
| 6 | 23 | employees using ChatGPT on company data | Problem | 11 | A 2026 incident pattern with no honest page; Dot's zero-retention answer is the mention |
| 7 | 30 | metric definitions document template | Problem | 11 | Essays exist; the template does not |
| 8 | 36 | AI data analyst test questions | Evaluation | 11 | The companion to rank 3; same evidence run |
| 9 | 44 | metric glossary for AI analytics | Evaluation | 11 | Root can build one on screen; nobody else can show that |
| 10 | 61 | cost per question AI analytics | Evaluation | 11 | Dot's credit model makes this answerable with a real number |
| 11 | 17 | hire another analyst or buy a tool | Problem | 10 | Nothing honest exists; the CFO reads this one |
| 12 | 28 | how to measure AI impact on data team | Problem | 10 | Dot's impact studies are the proof; the method is unwritten |
| 13 | 38 | AI analytics hallucination | Evaluation | 10 | The fear behind every evaluation; the eval run answers it |
| 14 | 40 | ongoing accuracy measurement | Evaluation | 10 | Evaluations in CI is in the docs with no narrative |
| 15 | 47 | how much context is enough | Evaluation | 10 | Inferred, but it is the question every analytics engineer asks on the first call |

### The three pieces for the trial, from this list

- **Piece 1**, from ranks 3, 8, 13 and 14: *How to know an AI data analyst is right before anyone relies on it.* The 25-question test, run in Dot's Evaluation on a public dataset, with the result table and the before-and-after of adding two context notes.
- **Piece 2**, from ranks 1, 2 and 4: *Your data team answers the same forty questions. Here is how to count them.* The audit template, then thirty typical requests run through Dot and classified: answered, needed context, still needs a human.

- **Piece 3**, from ranks 7 and 9: *Fifteen metric definitions to write before an AI analyst answers anyone.* Root building a glossary on screen, the diff, one wrong definition corrected, and the copyable template.

Together they are the path a buyer walks: count the problem, test the answer, prepare the ground. Ranks 5, 6, 10, 11 and 12 are the five future topics.

**One honest caveat.** Six of the fifteen are inferred, not observed. If Ahrefs shows no volume for "cost per question" or "how much context is enough", they drop and ranks 16 to 20 move up. That is the method working, not failing.

## What happens on the day, and after

**The first ninety minutes on 27 October.** Validate, do not re-research.

1. **Ahrefs, thirty minutes.** Every question scored 9 or above goes into Keywords Explorer for volume, difficulty and the top three ranking pages. Record it against the question. Expect the inferred ones to split: some will show real volume under slightly different wording, some will show nothing and drop.
2. **The eight AI prompts, twenty minutes.** Ask each in ChatGPT, Perplexity and Claude with web search. Record the cited domains. Where Querio is cited and Dot is not, that row is the evidence for the cluster. parse.gl already tracks how AI assistants describe Dot; use it as a second source for the baseline.
3. **Ten questions from sales calls, ten minutes.** Ask Rick and Théo directly: what did the last ten prospects ask on the first call? Those go into the bank as Observed with the strongest demand signal there is, and they will reorder the top fifteen.
4. **Re-rank, ten minutes.** Show the before and after. The questions that moved are the proof the method is honest.
5. **Propose the three pieces, ten minutes.** From the re-ranked list, not from this document.

The eight AI prompts:

1. How do I test whether an AI data analyst gives correct answers before rolling it out to my company?
2. My data team of three spends half its time answering Slack questions. How do I reduce ad hoc requests?
3. What metric definitions should I write before letting an AI answer business questions from our warehouse?

4. We are on Snowflake. Should we use Cortex Analyst or a third-party AI analyst?
5. People at my company are uploading data exports to ChatGPT. What should I offer them instead?
6. What does an AI data analyst cost per question, and how does that compare to an analyst’s time?
7. Why do AI analytics tools get less accurate over time?
8. How do I run a 30-day pilot of an AI data analyst that proves something?

**After the trial: the bank as the input layer of the content machine.** This document becomes a sheet with the same columns plus Ahrefs volume, difficulty, date validated and status (unwritten, drafted, published). Once a month, three things happen: new questions are added from sales calls, support tickets and the dbt Slack; scores are refreshed against what now ranks; and the top unwritten question becomes the next piece. Published pieces are re-scored on whether they rank and whether AI assistants cite them, which is the measurement plan feeding back into the question bank. That loop is what makes the workflow repeatable rather than a one-off, and it is the same shape as the signal engine: a scored list, a source for every row, and a weekly change driven by outcomes.